

Linux Commands Bible

1. File and Directory Commands

Command	Purpose	Example
pwd	Show current working directory	pwd → /home/user
ls	List files in a directory	ls -l
cd	Change directory	cd /etc
mkdir	Create new directory	mkdir projects
rmdir	Remove empty directory	rmdir old_folder
touch	Create empty file	touch notes.txt
cp	Copy files/directories	cp file1.txt backup/
mv	Move or rename files	mv old.txt new.txt
rm	Remove files/directories	rm file.txt
find	Search for files	find / -name 'config.txt'

2. Viewing and Editing Files

Command	Purpose	Example
cat	Display file contents	cat file.txt
more / less	Scroll through files	less file.txt
head	Show first lines	head -n 5 file.txt
tail	Show last lines	tail -n 10 log.txt
nano	Simple terminal editor	nano notes.txt
vim	Advanced text editor	vim code.c

3. File Permissions

Command	Purpose	Example
chmod	Change permissions	chmod 755 script.sh
chown	Change owner	chown user file.txt
chgrp	Change group	chgrp developers project

4. System Information

Command	Purpose	Example
uname	Show system info	uname -a
df	Disk usage	df -h

du	Directory space usage	du -sh /home
free	Memory usage	free -m
uptime	System running time	uptime
top	Real-time processes	top
htop	Better process viewer	htop

5. Process Management

Command	Purpose	Example
ps	Show running processes	ps aux
kill	Terminate process	kill 1234
killall	Kill by name	killall firefox
bg	Resume process in background	bg %1
fg	Bring background job to foreground	fg %1

6. Network Commands

Command	Purpose	Example
ping	Test connectivity	ping google.com
ifconfig / ip	Network details	ip a
netstat	Network connections	netstat -tuln
curl	Fetch from URL	curl example.com
wget	Download file	wget file.com/file.zip

7. Archive & Compression

Command	Purpose	Example
tar	Create/extract archives	tar -czvf backup.tar.gz folder/
zip	Zip files	zip archive.zip file1 file2
unzip	Extract zip	unzip archive.zip
gzip	Compress file	gzip bigfile.txt
gunzip	Decompress	gunzip bigfile.txt.gz

8. User Management

Command	Purpose	Example
whoami	Show current user	whoami
id	Show user/group IDs	id

adduser	Create new user	sudo adduser alice
passwd	Change password	passwd alice
usermod	Modify user	sudo usermod -aG sudo alice

9. Package Management

Command	Purpose	Example
apt update	Update package list	sudo apt update
apt upgrade	Upgrade packages	sudo apt upgrade
apt install	Install package	sudo apt install package
apt remove	Remove package	sudo apt remove package

10. Miscellaneous

Command	Purpose	Example
echo	Print text	echo 'Hello'
history	Show command history	history
alias	Create shortcut	alias ll='ls -l'
date	Show date/time	date
cal	Calendar	cal 2025
clear	Clear terminal	clear